

Program Coordination Case Study: Youth STEM Operations

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Competition Seasons | 2024-2025

Overview

- STEM education program serving students ages 5-12 through coding classes and competitive FIRST LEGO League (FLL) robotics teams.
- During my second consecutive competition season, balanced direct coaching responsibilities with multi-team operational coordination.
- Managed scheduling logistics, competition preparation, and communication workflows.
- Ensured smooth execution across teams during competition season.

The Challenge

- Coordinating multiple robotics teams with overlapping schedules.
- Managing competition timelines, judging sessions, and pit assignments.
- Balancing coaching responsibilities with operational oversight.
- Maintaining consistent communication between families and staff.
- Organizing materials and logistics for competition execution.

My Role & Actions

- Built and maintained centralized team schedules using Google Sheets.
- Structured competition-day timelines and planning documents.
- Coordinated logistics updates and schedule adjustments.
- Managed last-minute staff coverage conflicts.
- Organized preparation checklists and documentation.
- Balanced instructional duties alongside coordination responsibilities.

Tools Used

- Google Sheets (scheduling & tracking)
- Google Docs (planning & structured communication)
- Email and messaging workflows
- Checklists and event-planning templates

Impact & Results

- Improved visibility across team schedules and event logistics.
- Reduced last-minute coordination challenges.
- Streamlined communication between staff and families.
- Supported smooth execution of FIRST LEGO League competitions across multiple teams.
- Following a Rising Star Award in the previous season, teams progressed in the most recent season to earn 1st Place for Core Values (advancing directly to the NYC Championships), the Engineering Excellence Award, and 3rd Place for Core Values.

Professional Growth

- Strengthened operational organization under time pressure.
- Improved multi-stakeholder communication.
- Enhanced adaptability and conflict resolution skills.
- Demonstrated leadership while balancing dual responsibilities.